YANHENG LI

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Research Interests

Substantive: Political Communication, Misinformation, Social Media.
Methodological: Computational Social Science, Digital Trace Data, Network Analysis, Mixed Methods.

Education

- **Northwestern University** *2026.09 – present*
  PhD in Media, Technology, and Society; advised by Prof. Erik Nisbet Evanston, U.S.
- **Renmin University of China** *2022.09 – 2026.06*
  LL.B. in Politics, Economics and Philosophy (PPE) Beijing, China
- **Luiss Guido Carli** *2024.09 – 2025.02*
  Erasmus Exchange Student in Data Science Rome, Italy

Peer-Reviewed Publications

[1] **Li, Yanheng**., Wang, Da., and Wang, Yuping. (2025). *Understanding Voter Fraud Misinformation Videos during the 2024 Taiwan Election on YouTube.* Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction 9.7 (2025): 1-40. [PDF]

(a) Awarded with CSCW 2025 **Impact Recognition**, for strong examples of work that demonstrates or has clear potential to demonstrate real-world or practical impact.

Under Review Working Papers

[1] **Li, Yanheng**., Wang, Da., and Wang, Yuping. (2025). *A Framework for Analyzing Amplified Crisis Comments on YouTube*.

Work in Progress

[1] *The Politicization of Live Streaming and Affective Polarization: Evidence from "China Tour" Live Streaming on YouTube. (Manuscript Preparation)*

Selected Research Experience

- **Research Assistant in Computational Communication**
  Supervisor: Prof. Yingdan Lu, Northwestern University 2025.01 – Present
  - **Project: Analyzing Rednote TikTok-Refugees Posts During TikTok Ban.**
    Co-supervised by Prof. Lizhi Liu, Georgetown University
    - Processed and analyzed 80k+ large text posts from RedNote.
    - Built reproducible data-cleaning, coding, and validation workflows for large-scale social media data.
    - Conducted topic, sentiment, and toxicity analysis.
    - Validated the consistency and robustness of related findings.
- **Research Assistant in Social Media + HCI**
  Supervisor: Prof. Yuping Wang, Renmin University of China 2024.06 – Present
  - **Project 1: Understanding Voter Fraud Misinformation on YouTube.**
    - Collected and processed video, audio, and metadata from 5k+ YouTube uploads.
    - Built a structured data-processing and validation pipeline for large-scale media analysis.
    - Framed, wrote, and revised the research paper accepted at CSCW 2025.
  - **Project 2: Amplified Crisis Comments on YouTube.**
    - Collected and processed video, audio, metadata, and 1M comments from 20k+ YouTube uploads.
    - Built a data-curation workflow and conducted network-based amplification analysis.
    - Framed and wrote the research paper.

Selected Awards and Honors

- **Competition Awards**
  - **COMAP Scholarship Award** [Link] 2024.05
    10,000 USD, Outstanding Winner **(Rank 1st/28,900+)** in the Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling.
  - **First Prize in RUC Innovation Cup** 2024.05
    Top 10% in the 26th Academic Work Competition, Renmin University of China.
- **Scholarships**
  - **JD. "Qiushi Future Scholars" Student Research Scholarship** 2025.10
    10,000 CNY, Renmin University of China.
  - **ICBC Innovation Scholarship with "Innovation Star" Designation** 2025.04
    8,000 CNY, **Top 10/11,000+** in Renmin University of China.
  - **Principal's Scholarship for Excellent Exchange Student** 2024.10
    30,000 CNY, Renmin University of China.
  - **Student Academic Award** 2024.09
    5,000 CNY, **Top 2%** in Renmin University of China.
  - **Outstanding Cultural and Sports Leaders Scholarship** 2024.06
    600 CNY, Renmin University of China.

Selected Grants

- **Undergraduate Academic Grant** 2025.10
  8,100 CNY, Renmin University of China.
- **Student Research Grant** 2025.03
  5,000 CNY, Renmin University of China.
- **International Organization Talent Program Grant** 2024.01
  10,000 CNY, Renmin University of China.

Conferences and Presentations

- The 28th ACM SIGCHI Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social Computing (CSCW), Bergen, Norway, 2025.10
- Annual Conference of the Academic Community of Political Science and International Relations (presenting on Future Scholars Academic Poster Showcase), Beijing, China, 2024.07

Academic Services

- Student Fellow for *Center of Data Science* of School of International Studies in Renmin University of China.
  - The first undergraduate student fellow since the Center of Data Science was established in 2020.

Skills

- **Languages:** Mandarin. Taiwanese Hokkien. English (TOEFL:112; Listening:29, Reading:27, Writing:27, Speaking:29). French, basic. Italian, basic.
- **Programming:** R, Python (*data collection, statistical analysis, text processing, visualization*), Stata, LaTeX, Gephi, SQL.